

Problem

A branch voltage in an RLC circuit is described by

$$\frac{d^2v}{dt^2} + 4 \frac{dv}{dt} + 8v = 24$$

If the initial conditions are $v(0) = 0 = dv(0)/dt$, find $v(t)$.

Step-by-step solution

Step 1 of 5

Write the differential equation that describes series RLC circuit.

$$\frac{d^2v}{dt^2} + 4 \frac{dv}{dt} + 8v = 24$$

Solve this differential equation to find the voltage, $v(t)$.

The complete response of the circuit is,

$$v(t) = v_t(t) + v_{ss}(t)$$

Here,

$v_t(t)$ is the transient or natural response

$v_{ss}(t)$ is the steady-state response.

Find the natural response.

The characteristic equation is,

$$s^2 + 4s + 8 = 0$$

The roots of the characteristic equation are,

$$\begin{aligned} s_{1,2} &= \frac{-b \pm \sqrt{b^2 - 4ac}}{2a} \\ &= \frac{-4 \pm \sqrt{4^2 - (4)(1)(8)}}{2(1)} \\ &= \frac{-4 \pm \sqrt{16 - 32}}{2} \\ &= -2 \pm j2 \end{aligned}$$

Step 2 of 5

The roots are complex. Therefore, the transient response is,

$$v(t) = e^{-\alpha t} (B_1 \cos \omega_d t + B_2 \sin \omega_d t)$$

The standard form of characteristic roots are,

$$s = -\alpha \pm j\omega_d$$

Therefore,

$$\alpha = 2$$

$$\omega_d = 2$$

The natural response is,

$$v(t) = e^{-2t} (B_1 \cos 2t + B_2 \sin 2t) \dots\dots (1)$$

Step 3 of 5

The steady state response is,

$$v_{ss} = v(\infty)$$

Assume that the steady-state response is constant, K and substitute it in the differential equation.

$$\frac{d^2}{dt^2}(K) + 4 \frac{d}{dt}(K) + 8K = 24$$

$$8K = 24$$

$$K = 3$$

Therefore,

$$v_{ss} = 3 \text{ V}$$

Therefore, the total response is,

$$v(t) = 3 + e^{-2t} (B_1 \cos 2t + B_2 \sin 2t) \dots\dots (2)$$

Use the initial conditions to determine the values of B_1 and B_2 .

Substitute 0 for t in the equation of $v(t)$.

$$v(0) = 3 + e^{-2(0)} [B_1 \cos 2(0) + B_2 \sin 2(0)]$$

$$v(0) = 3 + B_1$$

Substitute 0 for $v(0)$.

$$0 = 3 + B_1$$

$$B_1 = -3$$

Step 4 of 5

Recall equation (2).

$$v(t) = 3 + e^{-2t} (B_1 \cos 2t + B_2 \sin 2t)$$

Differentiate equation with respect to t .

$$\frac{dv(t)}{dt} = -2e^{-2t} (B_1 \cos 2t + B_2 \sin 2t) + e^{-2t} (-2B_1 \sin 2t + 2B_2 \cos 2t)$$

Substitute 0 for t .

$$\begin{aligned} \frac{dv(0)}{dt} &= -2e^{-2(0)} [B_1 \cos 2(0) + B_2 \sin 2(0)] + e^{-2(0)} [-2B_1 \sin 2(0) + 2B_2 \cos 2(0)] \\ &= -2B_1 + 2B_2 \end{aligned}$$

Substitute 0 for $\frac{dv(0)}{dt}$ and -3 for B_1 .

$$0 = -2(-3) + 2B_2$$

$$0 = 6 + 2B_2$$

$$B_2 = -3$$

Step 5 of 5

Now calculate the voltage expression.

Recall equation (2).

$$v(t) = 3 + e^{-2t} (B_1 \cos 2t + B_2 \sin 2t)$$

Substitute -3 for B_1 and -3 for B_2 .

$$\begin{aligned} v(t) &= 3 - 3e^{-2t} \cos 2t - 3e^{-2t} \sin 2t \\ &= 3 - 3(\cos 2t + \sin 2t)e^{-2t} \\ &= 3[1 - (\cos 2t + \sin 2t)e^{-2t}] \text{ V} \end{aligned}$$

Thus, the expression for the voltage $v(t)$ is $\boxed{3[1 - (\cos 2t + \sin 2t)e^{-2t}]u(t) \text{ V}}$.